Year 10 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `Y10/Y10_Student_Paper_v3.1`. Version 3.1 is version 2 with the third reading text (Part C) removed: the listening, writing, maths, science and interview are unchanged from version 2. The reading paper is now Parts A and B (16 marks) in the same 15 minutes. Do not mix papers and instructions from different versions: the question numbers, marks and band guides differ.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y10_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

- **Listening** (16 marks): Part A is the version 1 talk, unchanged; **Part B** is the academic talk at the level of a lesson.
- **Reading** (16 marks): Part A is the version 1 menu; Part B is the version 1 article "Ten Minutes of Nothing" (questions 8 to 14).
- **Maths** (30 marks): three sections that are scored separately: **Fluency** (10), **Word questions** (8) and **Applied problems** (12). A scientific calculator is allowed in Section C only.
- **Writing, science, the interview and the shared files are unchanged.**

Who this is for. Students applying for **Year 10** (age 14 on 1 September), the first year of a **two-year IGCSE course**. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 8 (初二)**; a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 9 (初三). Ask the student and the family which grade and which textbooks they have used, because the order of topics differs between textbooks and regions. Background on Chinese school sequences, the English bands and the decision guide is in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

What it measures. The student's level of English in listening, reading, writing and speaking (bands A to E); their maths against all of Key Stage 3 and the start of the IGCSE Extended course, reported as three sub-scores (fluency, word questions and applied problems); their science against the end of Key Stage 3 (the UK Year 9 curriculum); and, through the interview, who they are, their future plans and their suitability for the programme. Section 6 explains how to read the results together to judge **readiness for IGCSE study in English**.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
1	Welcome	2	Assessor		These instructions
2	Listening: Part A (questions 1 to 8) and Part B (questions 9 to 16), 16 marks	about 15 (the recording)	Assessor plays the recording, or reads both scripts (Section 3.1); a small group is fine	Student paper pages 2 to 5; pencil; the recording	Student paper; grading sheet
3	Reading paper: Parts A and B (16 marks)	15	Student works alone	Student paper pages 6 to 9	
4	Writing: one task from two (16 marks)	10	Student works alone	Student paper pages 10 to 11	
5	Break	5		Water	
6	Maths: Section A Fluency, Section B Word questions, Section C Applied problems (30 marks)	25	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 12 to 18; pencil, rubber, ruler; **no calculator in Sections A and B**; a **scientific calculator for Section C only** (from page 16); no protractor	A scientific calculator for each student

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
7	Science: 7 questions (10 marks)	8	Student works alone; the assessor may read any question aloud	Student paper pages 19 to 21; no calculator	
8	Interview, opening with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen at **Level 9**	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Sentence Reading Card (laminated); a plain card to cover sentences	Reading front sheet; Interview sheet
	Total	**about 95** (allow 100)		A clock or timer	Final mark sheet

Marks go on the **grading sheet** (listening, writing, maths, science and readiness for IGCSE), the **Reading front sheet** (reading) and the **Interview sheet** (speaking).

For each candidate:

- the Year 10 student paper, version 3.1;
- the grading sheet (`Y10/Y10_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 7 to 10 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; laminate it);
- the other equipment in the table above: a clock or timer, a plain card to cover the sentences, and a scientific calculator for each student (with a pencil, rubber and ruler for each candidate).

The parent conversation (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`, about 15 minutes) can run at the same time with another member of staff. The written papers (tasks 2 to 7) can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; the interview is always 1:1.

2. Before you start

Room. Quiet, bright, a clock the student can see, the student paper face down, a pencil, rubber and ruler. Keep a scientific calculator for each student on your desk until they reach maths Section C. Glasses or hearing aids if the student uses them.

Say (welcome): "Hello, I am [name]. Thank you for coming today. These activities help us get to know you, so that we can help you when you join us. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets everything right, and that is fine. Do your best. If you do not know an answer, go on to the next question. Please write all your answers in English. In the English parts, I can only repeat the instructions. In maths and science, I can read any question to you. You can use a calculator only in the last section of the maths, and I will give it to you then. Do you have any questions before we start?"

Pace of speech. Year 10 students may still be learning English: speak steadily and clearly, with a short pause after each sentence, when you give instructions, read the listening scripts and read maths and science questions aloud. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

Access rules (the same in every year group, with the version 2 calculator rule)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	Maths and science
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not read the reading texts or questions aloud, explain words or translate. Instructions may be repeated in English.	Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as the student asks. You may point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Record the number of L questions on the grading sheet: it is evidence about English.
Answers	**All answers in English.** An answer in Chinese scores 0.	**All answers in English**: numbers, symbols, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0 (this includes the "Explain" and "Show" answers in maths Section C).
Calculator	Not used.	Maths Sections A and B: **no calculator**. Maths Section C: a **scientific calculator**. Science: no calculator.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics on the grading sheet.

Extra time, a reader or other arrangements for a known need are allowed: record them on the grading sheet.

Stopping rules

- The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Say: "That is fine. Thank you. We will go on to the next part."
- **Listening:** if the student scores 2 or fewer out of 8 in Part A (questions 1 to 8), you may leave out Part B: check Part A quickly in the minute after it. Say: "Thank you. That is the end of the listening." Record "Part B not given" on the grading sheet; the band then comes from Part A alone (band A). In a group, read Part B to everyone as usual; a student with 2 or fewer in Part A may sit quietly.
- **Reading paper:** if the student cannot answer any of Part A after about 4 minutes, let them stop and record it on the Reading front sheet. Do not move them on to Part B.
- **Writing:** if the student has written nothing in English after 3 minutes, say once: "Write anything you can in English: a few words or sentences about yourself is fine." Then let them stop when they wish.
- **Maths and science:** encourage the student to look at every page, because later questions on different topics may be easier for them. Do not stop early unless the student is distressed. Give the calculator when the student turns to Section C (page 16); in a group, give each student theirs when they reach that page. If a student goes back to Section A or B after that, take the calculator back while they work on it.
- If a student becomes upset at any point, stop, take a break, and continue only if they are happy to. Record it on the grading sheet.

Keeping the student at ease. Smile, use the student's name, and keep your voice calm. Do not say "right" or "wrong" during the tasks; say "thank you" instead. Give a two-minute warning before the end of the reading paper, maths and science. A student who finishes early may check their work quietly.

3. English

3.1 Listening (16 marks: Part A 8, Part B 8)

There are two parts, and you read each one twice. **Part A** is the version 1 careers day talk, unchanged: everyday listening. **Part B** is a short lesson-style talk with subject vocabulary, statistics, a correction and an implied opinion: the listening that IGCSE lessons need, at the level of a fluent speaker of 14 to 15.

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y10/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of Part A takes about 1 minute 43 seconds and of Part B about 2 minutes 57 seconds, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script. Play Part A and Part B as separate tracks if you may stop after Part A; otherwise the full track plays both.

Part A. Say: "Turn to the Listening page. There are two parts. In Part A, you will hear a short talk by an engineer on a careers day at a school. I will read it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 1 to 8." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Read the Part A script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Part B. Say: "Now turn to Part B, on page 4. You will hear a talk by a scientist, Professor Zhou Lan, about the climate of cities. I will read it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 9 to 16." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Read the Part B script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Read both scripts twice at the steady pace in Section 2. At each [pause], stop for about 3 seconds. Do not slow down for key words, repeat sentences or explain anything. Read Part B at the same pace as Part A: it is meant to sound like a lesson.

Timing. The recording takes about 15 minutes: Part A about 6 minutes 15 seconds and Part B about 8 minutes 38 seconds, with one minute to read each set of questions, the 10-second gaps between the two readings and one minute to finish each part. **Allow about 15 minutes** for the listening.

Script, Part A: Careers Day talk

Good morning, everyone. My name is Dr Liu Yan, and I'm an engineer. I work for a company in Shenzhen that designs electric buses. Some of you probably came to school on one of our buses this morning. [pause]

When I was your age, I wasn't sure what I wanted to do. I was quite good at art, and I loved drawing. But my favourite subject was physics, because I always wanted to know how things worked. At the weekends, I took old radios apart and tried to put them back together. [pause]

After school, I studied engineering at university for four years. Then I worked in a battery factory for two years. Now I lead a team of twelve people. [pause] Our newest bus can travel three hundred kilometres before it needs charging, and it charges in about ninety minutes. [pause]

People often think engineers sit alone at a computer all day. In fact, I spend most of my time talking: to my team, to bus drivers, and to the people who use our buses. Last year, an older passenger told us the steps were too high. So we changed the design. Now the floor of the bus goes down when it stops. [pause]

My advice to you is simple. Don't be afraid of getting things wrong. I got a lot of things wrong with those old radios. My parents weren't always happy about that! [pause] My first battery design failed every test, too. But each time it failed, I learnt something new. And remember: being good at maths is useful, but being good at listening is just as important. Thank you. [pause]

Part A answers (1 mark each; the same as version 1). Spelling does not matter in listening if the meaning is clear.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**B** (the bus)		
2	**Physics**		Art (she was good at art, but it was not her favourite); Maths (mentioned only at the end)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
3	**B** (taking a radio apart)		A (painting: she loved drawing, but that is not what she did at weekends)
4	**4**	four (years)	2 (the years in the battery factory)
5	**12**	twelve	
6	**300** (km)	three hundred	90 (the charging time in minutes)
7	**The radios might be broken, or not work again**	She broke them; she could not always put them back together; she got things wrong with the radios; she made a mess; it could be dangerous; they were worried about the radios	"She did not study"; "She liked art"; an answer about the bus
8	**To show that mistakes help you learn**	Do not be afraid of getting things wrong; failing is part of learning; each failure taught her something; even experts fail at first	"Because the battery was bad" with no idea of learning from it

Script, Part B: a talk about cities and heat

Good afternoon, everyone. My name is Professor Zhou Lan, and I study the climate of cities. [pause]

On a still summer night, a thermometer in a city centre will almost always read higher than one in the fields outside. Scientists call this the urban heat island effect. "Urban" means "to do with cities", and a city really is an island of heat in the cooler countryside. At night, a city centre is about three degrees warmer. Actually, let me correct that: three degrees is only the average, and in the largest cities, on the hottest nights, the difference can reach seven degrees. [pause]

So why does this happen? First, roads, concrete and dark roofs absorb the sun's energy during the day and release it slowly after sunset, so the city never really cools down. Second, cities have far fewer trees and plants, which cool the air through a process called evapotranspiration. It's a long word for a simple idea: water travels up from the soil, evaporates from the leaves and carries heat away, rather like sweat cooling your skin. Third, there is waste heat from traffic and from air conditioners, which pump hot air out into the street. As a result, the hotter the city becomes, the more people switch their air conditioners on, and the hotter the streets get: a vicious circle. [pause]

One solution is the green roof: a roof covered with living plants and built in layers. At the bottom is a waterproof layer that protects the building. Above that is a drainage layer, which allows extra water to flow away. Then comes a thin layer of soil, and finally the plants: tough species that can survive for weeks without rain. [pause]

In 2023, my team tested two roofs side by side on a school in Hangzhou. On a July afternoon, the surface of the ordinary dark roof reached sixty-eight degrees, whereas the green roof stayed at around thirty-one. The classrooms under the green roof were also about four degrees cooler, so the school used noticeably less electricity for air conditioning. [pause]

Green roofs also soak up rainwater like a sponge, which reduces flooding, and they give insects and birds somewhere to live. On the other hand, they are heavier and cost more to build, and builders often tell me they are simply too expensive. I sometimes wonder how much they think a city that is too hot to live in will cost. [pause]

Painting roofs white also helps, because a white surface reflects sunlight rather than absorbing it. However, a white roof doesn't hold any rainwater, and it doesn't give a single butterfly anywhere to live. [pause]

Your sports hall has a large flat roof, and at the moment it is simply collecting heat. I'll leave you to think about what else it could be doing. Thank you. [pause]

Part B answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the word is recognisable and the meaning is clear. Every answer is said in the script, and the questions follow the order of the script.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Specific detail (a number), after a correction	**7** (degrees)	seven; 7 °C; up to 7	**3**: the average, which she corrects ("Actually, let me correct that: three degrees is only the average"). An answer of 3 shows the student caught the first number but not the correction.
10	Note completion (a process)	**evaporates**	evaporate; evaporating; it evaporates; goes into the air; turns into vapour; recognisable spellings (evaporats, evapourates)	"travels" or "carries heat away" (already in the note); "sweat" (the comparison); "evapotranspiration" (the name of the whole process: the gap needs what the water does).
11	Note completion (a detail)	**air conditioners**	air conditioner; air conditioning; air-con; AC	"traffic" (already in the note); "cars"; "hot air" (what they pump out, not where the waste heat comes from); "the sun".
12	Process or sequence	soil **3**, plants **4**, a waterproof layer **1**, a drainage layer **2**		All four correct for the mark. Waterproof and drainage swapped is the usual error: the student heard the four layers but not "At the bottom … Above that …".
13	Specific detail (a number)	**68** (°C)	sixty-eight	31 (the green roof); 4 (the classrooms were four degrees cooler); 2023 (the year).
14	Inference joining two parts of the talk	**Rooms under a green roof stay cooler, so people use less air conditioning, so less hot air (waste heat) is pumped into the street.**	Any answer that links the green roof to using less air conditioning or less electricity for air conditioning: "the building is cooler, so people do not switch on the air conditioner so much"; "less air conditioning, so the streets do not get hotter"	"It has plants" or "it makes the city cooler" with no link to air conditioning; "it holds rainwater"; "it costs more". The question joins the vicious circle (the third cause) with the school's result (less electricity for air conditioning).
15	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**B**: she thinks they forget the cost of a city that is too hot		A is the opposite of her view; C mixes in the later point about white roofs; D is not said. She never says the builders are wrong: the student must hear the irony in "I sometimes wonder how much they think a city that is too hot to live in will cost."
16	Main idea or speaker's purpose	**B**: to explain a problem in cities and suggest how the school could help		A exaggerates (she does not say cities will soon be too hot to live in); C is not said; D is one part of the talk, not its purpose. The ending ("Your sports hall has a large flat roof … I'll leave you to think about what else it could be doing") carries the suggestion.

What is in the Part B script (for the English team): 465 words in 28 sentences (16.6 words a sentence on average); about 14% of the words are outside the 2000 most common English words (about 20.5% counting each word form separately; `wordfreq` lists, names left out). It explains a process and a chain of cause and effect (three causes, the vicious circle, the layers of a green roof); compares the city with the countryside, a dark roof with a green roof, and a green roof with a white one; gives statistics and a date; explains subject vocabulary in context (urban, the urban heat island effect, evapotranspiration, a drainage layer); corrects a number ("Actually, let me correct that"); implies opinions without stating them (the builders, white roofs, the sports hall); and uses discourse markers (first, second, third, as a result, whereas, on the other hand, however).

Band guide (version 2)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A** New to English
Part A 3 to 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C** Developing competence
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

If the two parts disagree in an unexpected way (for example Part A 5 or 6 with Part B 5 or more), use the interview to decide: the student may have lost easy marks in Part A through nerves or carelessness.

What to look for

- **Part A** checks everyday listening: questions 1 to 3 the main points, 4 to 6 exact details with distractors (two years, ninety minutes), and 7 and 8 implied meaning and the speaker's purpose.
- **Part B** is the step up. Questions 9 to 13 need exact detail from fast, connected speech, with distractors (3 degrees, 31 °C, the order of the layers); questions 14 to 16 need the student to join ideas, hear an attitude that is never stated and see the purpose of the whole talk. A student who gets 9 to 13 but not 14 to 16 follows the content of a lesson but not yet its argument.
- **Part A secure, Part B 0 to 2**: everyday English is fine, but lessons taught only by talk will be hard to follow at first. Plan visual support, key vocabulary in writing and frequent checks for understanding.
- Compare with listening in the interview. If the two differ by more than one band, use the interview as a check.

3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading page. There are two parts, A and B. Part B is harder. Read the texts yourself. I cannot read them to you or explain words. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 15 minutes." Give a two-minute warning.

General rules. Answers can be in the student's own words or copied from the text, unless the question says "copy" or "in your own words". Ignore spelling and grammar unless the answer cannot be understood. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: café menu (very accessible; picture support)

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
1	9:00	1	9 am; nine o'clock; 9. Do not accept 7:30 (that is Monday to Friday).
2	¥32	1	32; 32 yuan
3	Tomato and egg noodles; Spring rolls	2	1 mark for each correct tick, minus 1 for each wrong tick (minimum 0).
4	Tomato and egg noodles, **or** vegetable fried rice	1	Do not accept spicy tofu with rice (spicy) or spring rolls (a snack, not in "Noodles and rice").
5	Monday to Friday, 14:00 to 17:00	1	weekdays; 2 pm to 5 pm. Days and times both needed.
6	(Your) student card	1	student ID
7	Tell the staff before you order	1	tell the staff; tell the waiter; ask the staff

Part B: "Ten Minutes of Nothing" (the version 1 Part C, unchanged except for the question numbers: a non-fiction opinion article, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 14)

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
8	Retrieval	They reach for their phones	1	look at, pick up or use their phones
9	Vocabulary in context	immediate	1	

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
10	Retrieval and understanding	That what we are doing is not satisfying, so we should look for something better	1	Either idea; "it is a signal to change what we are doing". Do not accept "that we are tired".
11	Retrieval	They thought of more ideas (more uses for the plastic cups)	1	were more creative; had more ideas. Do not accept "they copied numbers".
12	Fact and opinion	Fact, Opinion, Fact, Opinion	2	All four correct: 2. Three correct: 1. Two or fewer: 0.
13	Writer's purpose	To show that her idea is reasonable, not extreme: she is not against phones	1	to answer readers who think she wants to ban phones; to make her small suggestion seem easy; humour to keep the reader on her side, if linked to her point
14	Writer's purpose	To get the reader's attention and make them think about their own life	1	to involve or "hook" the reader; to make readers realise they never do nothing. Do not accept "because it is a question".

Band guide (version 3.1; use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 3	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 3 to 5	**C** Developing competence
Part B 6 to 8	**D** Competent, or **E** Fluent (see below)

D or E. Part B is the age-level text, so 6 or more shows at least a competent reader. Give **E** only when Part B is 7 or 8 **and** the sentence reading screen (meaning checks and fluency) and the writing also point to E. Version 3.1 has no text above age level, so the reading paper alone cannot confirm band E.

Record the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes on the **Reading front sheet**, and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- **Part B** (the version 1 article) is age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 14, and it is the hardest text on this paper. A Part B score of 7 or 8 shows a secure reader of age-level texts; whether the student reads like a fluent speaker has to come from the sentence reading screen and the writing as well (see the band guide).
- **Strong readers** in Part B retrieve exact details (8, 10 and 11), tell fact from opinion (12) and explain the writer's purpose in their own words rather than copying (13 and 14). Copying whole lines that are in the right place but do not answer the question is the commonest sign of a band D reader.
- **An English barrier** looks like: Part A secure, Part B patchy or copied lines. A student who reads aloud well (sentence reading) but scores low on Part B may be decoding without understanding: see the meaning checks on the Reading front sheet.
- **Speed.** Note where the student was when time ran out, on the Reading front sheet. IGCSE papers are long; a student who is accurate but very slow will need reading practice and, possibly, an access arrangement assessment if there is a specific need.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task, A or B, and tick the box. You can plan in the box, then write on the lines. You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can." Do not explain the tasks or words.

The tasks. Task A (descriptive): describe a busy place (a market, a train station or a festival) so that the reader can see, hear and smell it. Task B (persuasive): an article for the school website on whether every student should volunteer for one week each year, with an opinion, reasons and examples. The plan is not marked.

Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 fall between the descriptions).

Criterion	0	2	4 (what a fluent 14 year old would do)
Content and organisation	Nothing relevant in English, or a few words copied from the task.	Relevant to the task; ideas in a sensible order but little developed; may be one block of text; the description is a list of things, or the article lists reasons without explaining them.	Well developed and clearly organised in paragraphs. Description: a clear sense of place built up through the senses, a viewpoint or mood, a shape (for example moving through the place, or from morning to night). Article: a clear position, reasons developed with examples, some awareness of the other side, a conclusion; written for website readers.
Vocabulary	Isolated words, or only words from the prompt.	Everyday words used correctly but repeated ("many people", "very busy", "good"); a few words chosen for effect; simple linking (and, but, because).	Wide and precise vocabulary chosen for effect (sounds, smells, movement; persuasive phrases); a range of linking words (however, moreover, as a result, although); some figurative language that works.
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Mostly simple sentences, some joined with and, but, because; frequent errors in verb forms, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear.	A variety of sentence types used for effect, including complex sentences and some short sentences for impact; verb forms controlled; errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Mostly impossible to read.	Common words spelt correctly; capital letters and full stops mostly correct; errors in less common words.	Almost all words spelt correctly, including ambitious ones; a range of punctuation (commas in lists and after openers, question marks, apostrophes, colons) used correctly.

Band by best fit, using the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and the notes below. The total is a check, not a rule: as a rough guide, totals of 0 to 3 usually go with A, 4 to 7 with B, 8 to 10 with C, 11 to 13 with D and 14 to 16 with E.

Band	Writing at Year 10 entry
A	Name, isolated words or copied phrases; may write in Chinese.
B	A few short sentences on the topic, with frequent errors; meaning mostly clear.
C	A short connected piece (often 60 to 120 words) with some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; little paragraphing.
D	An organised piece (often 120 to 200 words) with paragraphs and a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; some varied vocabulary.
E	See below.

Band E writing at this age. A fluent 14 year old usually writes 180 to 280 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with controlled, varied sentences, precise vocabulary chosen for its effect on the reader, and accurate spelling and punctuation. The description creates a mood rather than listing objects; the article argues, gives evidence and examples, and speaks directly to its reader. This is roughly the level a First Language English IGCSE course starts from.

What to look for

- Typical features of English from speakers of Chinese (missing articles, plural -s, past tense -ed, third person -s) are normal at bands C and D. Do not let them alone pull a well-organised, well-developed piece below D.
- A memorised opening ("Nowadays, with the development of society") or memorised essay phrases followed by very simple writing shows exam training more than fluency: band by what the student can produce independently.
- For IGCSE, the gap between the writing band and the other bands matters: writing is assessed in almost every subject. If writing is two bands below reading, name it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

3.4 Interview, speaking and sentence reading (15 minutes, 1:1)

The questions and the speaking band descriptors are in the **Interviewer guide** (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`), and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`).

The sentence reading rules are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`, the student reads from `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, and the results go on the **Reading front sheet**. All are in English.

- **Sentence reading first** (3 to 5 minutes). Year 10 starts at **Level 9 (sentence 25)**. Follow the start, going-back and stopping rules and the scoring in the guide. It gives total points out of 72, an indicative reading age, meaning checks and a fluency rating, which you record on the Reading front sheet. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1.
- **Interview** (about 10 minutes): choose questions from each block in the Interviewer guide, including **future plans and aspirations** and the **Year 10 only** questions about IGCSE subject choices and starting a two-year course in English. Use the easier and stretch prompts so that every student can show their best spoken English. Ask the questions at the pace in Section 2, the same for every candidate.
- **Speaking band:** give it using the descriptors in the Interviewer guide, and record it on the Interview sheet. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths page. You have 25 minutes. There are three sections. In Sections A and B, you may not use a calculator. When you get to Section C, on page 16, I will give you a calculator. Write your answers in the boxes and show your working. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can, and look at every page."

The example box at the start of Section A shows what the command words and symbols mean (simplify fully, surd form, make … the subject, f(x), fg(x), $f^{-1}(x)$); the example at the start of Section B shows what "Write an equation, then solve it" means. They are there so that an English phrase or an unfamiliar symbol does not hide maths the student can do.

Section	Questions	Marks	Calculator	What it measures
A Fluency	1 to 6	10	No	Algebra and number at the level of all of Year 9 and the start of IGCSE Extended, with no context: surds, negative and fractional indices, factorising with $a \neq 1$, algebraic fractions, rearranging with the subject twice, function notation, the quadratic formula. Demanding on purpose: these students usually find routine algebra easy.
B Word questions	7 to 10	8	No	Maths given only in sentences, with no diagram: the student must read, decide what to do and, usually, form an equation. A reverse percentage, simultaneous equations from ticket prices, a quadratic from a rectangle, and combined rates.
C Applied problems	11 to 16	12	Scientific	Multi-step problems in real contexts with a chart, a table or a diagram: an estimated mean, depreciation, similar bottles and best value, probability without replacement, trigonometry in an unfamiliar context (a building rule for wheelchair ramps), and bounds. Questions 13, 15 and 16 ask the student to show or explain a decision.

Calculator. Section C only. Before question 15, check that the calculator shows D or DEG (degrees). Many students from Chinese middle schools rarely use a calculator in maths lessons, so note how fluently they use one (powers, tan) in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet: IGCSE calculator papers need it.

Marking. M = method mark, A = accuracy mark (depends on the method), B = independent mark. A correct answer with no working gets full marks unless the scheme says otherwise: in questions 8 and 9 (which ask for an equation) a correct answer with no equation scores 1, and in questions 13, 15 and 16 a tick with no figures or reason scores 0. Units are not needed unless stated. Working in numbers and symbols is fine; any words must be in English (a reason written in Chinese scores 0, but the figures beside it still count).

What a Year 10 entrant may not have been taught. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed **Grade 8 (初二)**, so **algebra is usually a strength**: by then most have done factorising (因式分解), algebraic fractions and equations with fractions (分式, 分式方程), surds including rationalising the denominator (二次根式), negative integer indices, Pythagoras (勾股定理) and linear functions (一次函数, written $y = kx + b$). **Grade 9 (初三) topics may not have been taught yet**: quadratic equations and the formula (一元二次方程), probability (概率),

similarity (相似) and trigonometry (锐角三角函数). Some early IGCSE content on this paper is taught in Chinese senior high school, or not at all, so it **may not have been taught** even to a strong student: fractional indices (分数指数幂), function notation with composite and inverse functions, volume scale factors, and upper and lower bounds. Use NT and judge whether the student would reach the expected band once taught: a strong Grade 8 student usually learns these quickly.

Section A: Fluency (no calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Surds: simplifying and rationalising	$2\sqrt{3}$ ($k = 2$)	B1. ($\sqrt{48} = 4\sqrt{3}$ and $6/\sqrt{3} = 2\sqrt{3}$.) An answer of $-2\sqrt{3}$ usually means $6/\sqrt{3}$ was written as $6\sqrt{3}$: rationalising is not secure.	Secure (Grade 8, 二次根式, 分母有理化).
2	Negative and fractional indices	1/9	B1. An answer of 9 (the minus sign ignored) or −18 ($27 \times -2/3$) scores 0: note which.	Negative integer indices are Grade 8; fractional indices are senior high school: may not have been taught. A student who sees $27 = 3^3$ may still reason it out.
3	Factorising with $a \neq 1$; simplifying an algebraic fraction	$(2x - 1)/(x - 3)$	M1 for $(2x - 1)(x + 3)$ or $(x + 3)(x - 3)$ seen; A1 for $(2x - 1)/(x - 3)$. Cancelling terms instead of factors (for example crossing out the x^2) scores 0 and is worth noting.	Usually secure (Grade 8, 分式, 因式分解): the denominator (a difference of two squares) is core Grade 8. Factorising a three-term quadratic, especially with $a \neq 1$ (十字相乘法), is extension material in some textbooks, so the numerator may not have been taught.
4	Rearranging with the subject twice	$x = (y + 3)/(y - 2)$	M1 for $y(x - 1) = 2x + 3$ and the x terms collected on one side ($xy - 2x = y + 3$, or equivalent); A1 for $x = (y + 3)/(y - 2)$. Accept equivalents, for example $(-y - 3)/(2 - y)$. An answer with x still on both sides scores M1 at most.	Usually secure: the algebra is Grade 8. "Make x the subject" is the English phrase to watch (it is in the example box).
5	Function notation: composite and inverse functions	(a) 17 (b) $f^{-1}(x) = (x + 1)/3$	(a) B1. An answer of 27 is gf(2) (the functions in the wrong order); 30 is f(2) × g(2). (b) B1. Accept $x/3 + 1/3$ and equivalents, or $y = (x + 1)/3$. An answer of $1/(3x - 1)$ scores 0: it confuses the inverse with the reciprocal.	Function notation, composite and inverse functions are senior high school in China: may not have been taught. The example box explains the notation; a student who uses it correctly after reading it is showing the learning IGCSE needs.
6	Equation with algebraic fractions; the quadratic formula; surd form	$x = 2 + \sqrt{6}$ or $x = 2 - \sqrt{6}$	M1 for a correct quadratic, $x^2 - 4x - 2 = 0$ (from $3x + 2(x + 1) = x(x + 1)$); A1 for $2 \pm \sqrt{6}$. Accept $(4 \pm \sqrt{24})/2$. Correct decimals (4.45 and −0.45) score M1 only, because surd form was asked for.	Equations with fractions are Grade 8 (分式方程), so the M1 is within reach. The quadratic formula (公式法) is Grade 9: may not have been taught.

Section B: Word questions (no calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
7	Reverse percentage (an increase)	¥200	M1 for 230 ÷ 1.15, or 115% = 230, or $1.15x = 230$; A1 for 200. An answer of 195.50 (230 × 0.85, 15% taken off the new price) scores 0: it shows the percentage was applied to the wrong amount.	Secure (Grade 6 percentages; Grade 7 equations).
8	Simultaneous equations from a context	Adult ¥50, student ¥35	M1 for both equations correct ($3a + 4s = 290$ and $2a + 5s = 275$) with a correct step to eliminate or substitute; A1 for both values. Both values correct with no equations (trial): 1 mark.	Secure (Grade 7, 二元一次方程组 and its applications).
9	Forming and solving a quadratic from a perimeter and an area	Length 12 cm, width 5 cm	B1 for a correct equation in one unknown, $x(17 - x) = 60$ or $x^2 - 17x + 60 = 0$ (or the pair $x + y = 17$ and $xy = 60$); B1 for 12 and 5, either way round. Correct answer with no equation: 1 mark. An equation with 34 as the length plus the width ($x(34 - x) = 60$) means the perimeter was not halved: 0 for the equation.	Forming the equation is Grade 7 and 8 algebra. Solving a quadratic is Grade 9 and may not have been taught, but factorising (Grade 8) or a sensible trial finds 5 and 12.
10	Combined rates	2 hours 24 minutes	M1 for 1/4 + 1/6 = 5/12 of the tank an hour, or 2.4 hours, or another correct method (in 12 hours A fills 3 tanks and B fills 2, so 5 tanks take 12 hours); A1 for 2 hours 24 minutes (accept 144 minutes). 2 hours 40 minutes (2.4 read as 2 hours 40) is M1 A0. 5 hours (the mean) or 10 hours (the sum) scores 0: the student has not pictured two pumps working together.	Secure maths: a classic work problem (工程问题) from primary school and Grade 7. If it is wrong, the English is the likely barrier: read it aloud.

Section C: Applied problems (scientific calculator)

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
11	Estimated mean from a frequency chart	8.2 minutes	M1 for the midpoints 2, 6, 10 and 14 used with the frequencies 6, 14, 12 and 8 read from the chart (12 + 84 + 120 + 112 = 328), or 328 ÷ 40; A1 for 8.2. Using the upper ends of the groups (10.2) or the lower ends (6.2) scores 0. 328 ÷ 4 = 82 (dividing by the number of groups) is M1 A0.	Usually secure: Grade 8 statistics estimates a mean from class midpoints (组中值); frequency charts are Grade 7.
12	Depreciation (a repeated percentage decrease)	6 years	M1 for at least two more correct values in the table (4646.40, 4088.83, 3598.17, 3166.39, 2786.42; rounded to the nearest yuan is fine), or 6000×0.88^n for some $n \geqslant 2$, or $0.88^5 \approx 0.528$ and $0.88^6 \approx 0.464$; A1 for 6. An answer of 5 usually comes from taking ¥720 (12% of ¥6000) off every year: simple, not compound, decrease (0).	Compound change is not usually taught as such in Chinese middle school; repeated percentage change appears in Grade 9 (增长率 problems). With the table and a calculator, most strong students can reason it out.
13	Similar shapes: volume scale factor; best value (Show)	The large bottle	M1 for the volume scale factor $1.5^3 = 3.375$, or "the large bottle holds 675 ml"; A1 for "large" with a correct comparison: 675 ml for ¥36 against 200 ml for ¥12 (¥0.053 against ¥0.06 a millilitre; 18.75 ml against 16.7 ml a yuan; or 3.375 times the juice for 3 times the price). Using the length factor (300 ml) or the area factor (450 ml) leads to "small" and scores 0: this is the error the question is designed to find.	Similarity is Grade 9 (相似): may not have been taught. Volume scale factors are not usually in the Chinese middle-school course.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
14	Probability without replacement	8/15	M1 for 7/10 × 6/9 (= 42/90 or 7/15) or 3/10 × 2/9 (= 6/90 or 1/15); A1 for 8/15. Accept 48/90, 0.533 (0.53 or better), 53.3%. 0.58 (with replacement: 0.49 + 0.09) scores 0: the student missed "eats it". 7/15 alone (two lemons only) is M1 A0.	Grade 9 (概率, 树状图): may not have been taught.
15	Trigonometry in an unfamiliar context (Explain)	No: the ramp is too steep	M1 for a correct way to compare: $h = 6 \times \tan 5° = 0.52(5)$ m against the 0.5 m allowed over 6 m; or $\tan 5° = 0.087(5)$ against $1/12 = 0.083(3)$; or $\tan^{-1}(1/12) = 4.76°$ against 5°; or a rise of $12 \times \tan 5° = 1.05$ m over 12 m. A1 for "No" (too steep) with the correct figures. A height rounded to 0.5 m too early, leading to "Yes", is M1 A0. Using sin with 6 m ($6 \times \sin 5° = 0.523$) treats the ground as the slope: M0, even though it reaches "No". $\tan 5 = -3.38$ means the calculator is in radians: note it.	Grade 9 (锐角三角函数): may not have been taught. This is the unfamiliar context: the trigonometry is routine, but the student must turn a building rule into a calculation and explain the decision.
16	Upper bounds (Explain)	No	M1 for the upper bound 77.5 kg used ($8 \times 77.5 = 620$); A1 for "No" because 620 > 615, so the boxes could be over the maximum load. Using 75 kg (600, "Yes") scores 0: this is the answer a student gets without bounds, which is why the question separates them. Using 80 kg (640, "No") scores 0: the conclusion is right, but the bound is wrong.	Bounds are not usually taught in Chinese middle school (rounding, 近似数, is Grade 7): may not have been taught. A student who reasons "each box is at most 77.5 kg" without using the word "bound" gets full marks.

Sub-scores and total: Fluency (questions 1 to 6) / 10; Word questions (7 to 10) / 8; Applied (11 to 16) / 12; total / 30.

Band guide (version 2, provisional, for a harder paper; review after the first 20 to 30 candidates): 0 to 10 (under 35%): **1** Below expected; 11 to 16 (35 to 54%): **2** Working towards; 17 to 22 (55 to 74%): **3** Expected; 23 to 30 (75% or more): **4** Greater depth, likely top set.

Not tested in version 2 (not enough time): inequalities, simultaneous equations with one linear and one quadratic equation (question 9 comes close), density and pressure (science question 3 tests pressure), inverse proportion and bearings. Ask about them in the interview if they matter for setting.

Reading the three sub-scores

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency high (7 or more out of 10), **word questions low** (3 or less out of 8)	The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier.	Read the word questions aloud in English and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (mark L). If the student then solves them, record "English barrier in maths" on the grading sheet. This student needs maths vocabulary and practice in reading problems, not a lower tier.
Fluency and word questions high, **applied low** (5 or less out of 12)	The student calculates and sets up equations well but is less practised in multi-step problems in context, choosing a method and explaining a decision. Check the NT topics first: questions 13 to 16 include Grade 9 and early IGCSE content.	Teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. Practice with "explain" and "show that" questions.
All three high (band 4)	A strong mathematician who can read and apply.	Extended tier; likely top set.
Fluency low, word questions and applied higher	Unusual for a student from a Chinese mainstream school; more common from a bilingual or international school where formal algebra comes later.	Check which algebra has been taught. The Extended tier may still fit, with an algebra catch-up plan and a review after one term.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
All three low, not explained by NT or L	Gaps in earlier learning, or a possible learning need.	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).

What to look for

- **Strong responses** show organised working, correct notation and decisions backed by figures (questions 13, 15 and 16), and attempt the Grade 9 and IGCSE topics even when they are new.
- **A correct tick with no reason** (questions 13, 15 and 16) is common from students used to answer-only questions. It scores 0, but it is a habit that can be taught quickly, not a gap in maths: note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- **English or maths?** Question 10 is maths that almost every Chinese-school student knows well (a work problem). If it is wrong or blank but the student solves it once it is read aloud, the barrier is English. The same check works for questions 7 to 9.
- **Weak responses** show errors on taught topics (questions 1, 3, 4, 7, 8, 10 and 11), not just on NT topics. If most of the lost marks are NT questions (2, 5, 6, 9, 12 to 16), write the likely band once taught in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science page. You have 8 minutes. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can."

What a Year 10 entrant may not have been taught. In Chinese middle schools, biology runs from Grade 7, physics starts in Grade 8 (motion and speed, force, pressure, simple machines and efficiency) and chemistry only in Grade 9. A Year 10 entrant has usually done **biology and some physics but no chemistry**. Questions 6 and 7 may not have been taught: mark NT rather than reading this as weak science, and judge scientific thinking from question 4.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Specialised cells	B (root hair cell)	B1	Usually secure (Grade 7 biology: cells, roots, blood).
2	Distance-time graph and speed	(a) He stopped (not moving) (b) 6 m/s	(a) B1: stopped; waiting; at traffic lights. Do not accept "going slowly". (b) B1 for 6 (1200 ÷ 200).	Secure (Grade 8 physics, 速度 and distance-time graphs).
3	Pressure	300 N/m²	B1. Accept 300 Pa. An answer of 1200 (600 × 2) scores 0.	Secure (Grade 8 physics, 压强).
4	Factors affecting photosynthesis: pattern, variables, evaluating a method	(a) The further away the lamp, the fewer bubbles (b) One control variable (c) One sensible improvement	(a) B1: must link both variables (closer means more bubbles is fine). (b) B1: the same pondweed, the same water temperature, the same volume of water, the same lamp or bulb, the same counting time. Do not accept "distance" or "number of bubbles". (c) B1: repeat each distance and find a mean; count for longer; collect and measure the gas instead of counting bubbles (bubbles differ in size); keep the temperature the same (the lamp heats the water).	Photosynthesis is secure (Grade 7 biology). Evaluating a method is less familiar: score what the student writes.
5	Efficiency	0.75	B1. Accept 75% and 3/4. An answer of 150 or 1.33 scores 0.	Usually secure (Grade 8 physics, 机械效率), although energy transfer diagrams may be new.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
6	Atomic structure	7	B1 (3 protons + 4 neutrons). An answer of 3 (protons only) or 10 (all particles) scores 0.	Chemistry is Grade 9: may not have been taught.
7	Balancing an equation	2	B1	Chemistry is Grade 9: may not have been taught, but the particle picture lets a student count atoms.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 3: **1**; 4 to 5: **2**; 6 to 8: **3**; 9 to 10: **4**. Look at the NT questions before deciding.

Not tested this year (not enough time): diffusion, groups in the periodic table, rates of reaction, energy resources, waves, DNA and inheritance. Ask about them in the interview if they matter for subject choices.

What to look for

- **Working scientifically** (question 4) is the best guide to IGCSE science readiness: a student who describes a pattern, names a control variable and suggests a real improvement is ready for practical work in English, even with chemistry NT.
- **An English barrier** looks like: blank or wrong answers that become right when you read the question aloud. Science vocabulary in English (specialised, efficiency, variable, mass number) is often the gap: note the words the student did not know in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- **Strong responses** use units (m/s, N/m^2) and give precise answers in question 4 (for example "repeat three times and calculate a mean").

6. Readiness for IGCSE

This section is guidance for the school to confirm, against its own admissions policy, the IGCSE syllabuses it offers (for example Cambridge IGCSE or Pearson Edexcel International GCSE), the entry requirements of its own sixth form or diploma programme, and the support it can provide. It is not a set of fixed rules. Record the results on the grading sheet (Section 7) first, then read the results together.

English is the gateway. Every IGCSE subject except other languages is taught and examined in English, with long texts, extended written answers and command words such as describe, explain and evaluate. Look at the overall English band, and most closely at **reading and writing**, because the exams depend on them. Academic English usually develops more slowly than conversation: as a planning assumption, a student rarely moves up more than about one band a year in academic reading and writing, even with good support. A student at band C at the start of Year 10 may still be at C or D when the exams come.

English band	What it usually means for IGCSE study in English	English course that may fit best
A New to English	Cannot yet follow subject lessons in English. Direct entry to a two-year IGCSE course is not usually advisable (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).	A preparatory or foundation route, or a later start, if the school has one.
B Early acquisition	Can follow simple, supported lessons, but IGCSE texts and exam questions will be very hard for most of Year 10.	Only with an English as a Second Language course, a reduced subject load and close review, if the school's policy allows.
C Developing competence	Can follow most lessons with support; subject vocabulary and extended writing will slow progress. Maths and the sciences are usually more accessible than essay-based subjects.	**English as a Second Language**, with support for subject language.
D Competent	Usually ready for IGCSE courses taught in English, with some support for academic writing.	English as a Second Language at the higher level, or First Language English if reading is band E **and** writing is a strong D or E (see below). Check with the English department.

English band	What it usually means for IGCSE study in English	English course that may fit best
E Fluent	Ready for IGCSE study in English.	**First Language English** (and English Literature, if offered).

What English band does a student realistically need? As a working guide for the school to test: **band C or above in reading and writing**, with listening and speaking at C or above, to follow IGCSE courses taught in English with support, and **band D or above** to follow them with little extra support. Review these thresholds once the first groups of students have taken their IGCSEs.

What the version 3.1 English results add. The listening can tell a competent student (D) from a fluent one (E); the reading paper has no text above age level, so it can show a competent reader but cannot on its own confirm a fluent one. Use the hardest parts as the evidence for IGCSE:

- **Listening Part B** is the best guide to following lessons taught by talk. Part B 6 or more: the student can follow a lesson-style explanation with subject vocabulary. Part B 0 to 2 with Part A secure: everyday listening is fine, but lessons will need visual support and key vocabulary in writing at first.
- **Reading Part B** ("Ten Minutes of Nothing") is the age-level text and the hardest reading on this paper. Part B 7 or 8, with writing at E or a strong D: close to the reading of a fluent speaker. Part B 6 or more otherwise: a competent reader of age-level texts, who will need support with the longest IGCSE texts. Because version 3.1 has no text above age level, when First Language English is being considered, confirm it with the English department (for example with a further reading task).

English as a Second Language or First Language English? First Language English assumes the reading and writing of a fluent speaker: analysing how writers use language, and writing at length for different purposes. It is usually the better fit only when reading is band E (Part B 7 or 8, with the sentence reading screen also pointing to E: see 3.2) and writing is band E or a strong D. Because version 3.1 has no reading text above age level, confirm the reading with the English department first. For most students at band C or D, an English as a Second Language course is the better fit: it teaches the reading, writing, listening and speaking needed for study, and a good grade is more achievable. Check what the school's sixth form, diploma programme and likely universities ask for, because some ask for a particular course or grade; tell the family early.

Maths: Extended or Core tier, and what support. Read the total band with the three sub-scores (Section 4), allowing for NT.

Maths result	What it suggests (for the school to confirm)
Band 4 (23 or more)	**Extended tier**, likely top set. Consider additional or further maths if the school offers it.
Band 3 (17 to 22)	**Extended tier.** NT marks on the Grade 9 and early IGCSE topics (fractional indices, functions, the quadratic formula, similarity, probability, trigonometry, bounds) are expected for a Grade 8 student and are usually caught up in the first term.
Fluency 7 or more, word questions 3 or less (any band)	**Extended tier with support for the English of maths**: maths vocabulary, reading word problems, writing short explanations in English. The gap is English, not maths: do not place in Core for this reason alone.
Fluency and word questions secure, applied 5 or less	**Extended tier**, with teaching in problem solving, choosing a method and explaining ("show that", "explain"). Review after one term.
Band 2 (11 to 16), mostly NT and L	**Extended tier is still possible**: judge the band once taught, and review after six weeks.
Band 2 with errors on taught topics (questions 1, 3, 4, 7, 8, 10, 11)	**Core tier at first**, with a learning plan for the gaps and a review after one term; move to Extended if the gaps close.
Band 1 not explained by NT or English	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9). If an offer follows, maths support and the Core tier at first. A band 1 that NT or L does explain is treated as band 2 (the guide, Section 9).

Science. No chemistry is normal for this age group (science questions 6 and 7 NT). Look at question 4 and the biology and physics questions. Strong science (band 3 or 4) with English D or E may suit separate sciences; with

English B or C, a combined or co-ordinated science course, or fewer science subjects in the first year, may be more manageable while English grows.

Reading the results together (examples of common profiles)

Profile	What it suggests	A possible plan (for the school to confirm)
English D or E; maths 3 or 4; science 3 or 4 (allowing for NT)	Ready for a full IGCSE programme.	Full subject load; English course by the table above; Extended maths.
English E, with listening Part B high and reading Part B 7 or 8; writing E or a strong D	Listens like a fluent speaker and reads close to it.	First Language English (and Literature, if offered), if the English department agrees.
English C; maths fluency high, word questions well below it	Strong maths; English is the barrier.	English as a Second Language with subject-language support; Extended maths with vocabulary support; not too many essay-based subjects in Year 10.
English C or D; maths fluency and word questions high, applied low	Strong calculation and algebra; less practised in problem solving and explaining.	Extended maths with explicit teaching of problem solving and "explain" questions; review after one term.
English C; maths 2 with NT on Grade 9 and early IGCSE topics; chemistry NT	Likely to manage with support.	English as a Second Language; a learning plan for the NT maths topics and for chemistry; maths tier decided after a six-week review.
English B, any maths and science	The English gap is too wide for most IGCSE content in two years without intensive support.	Offer only with an English as a Second Language course, a reduced subject load and close review, if the school's policy allows; otherwise discuss a preparatory route or a later start (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9).
English D or E; maths band 1 on taught topics	Not an English issue.	Further assessment before a decision (`00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9): look for gaps in earlier learning or a possible learning need. If an offer follows, maths support and the Core tier at first.
Strong results, but the interview shows the IGCSE plan is the family's, not the student's	Readiness is not only academic.	Talk with the family and student about subject choices and workload before an offer (Interview sheet, suitability strands). A serious mismatch, or any strand rated 1, goes to the head of section before any offer.

Use the Year 10 interview questions (IGCSE subject choices, managing a two-year course in English) to judge whether the student's plans are realistic and their own. Record the readiness judgement on the grading sheet (the readiness for IGCSE boxes and the assessor's comment) and on the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

7. Recording the results

1. **Mark the student paper.** Every question has a mark box.
2. **Copy the totals onto the grading sheet** (`Y10_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). Record there too whether Part B of the listening was given, the maths sub-scores and profile (Section 4), the NT topics and L questions, the writing task chosen (A or B), any access arrangements and your comment.
3. **Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`): the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes.
4. **Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet** before the interview.
5. **After the interview, put together** the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days. Write "v3.1" beside the scores on it: the listening is out of 16 (as in version 2), the reading paper is out of 16 (Parts A and B only) and the maths has three sub-scores. The overall English band is the band most skills sit in: name any skill that is two or more bands lower.
6. **File the marked student paper with them** (or shred it under the school's policy).

Year 10 only: readiness for IGCSE. Read the results together with Section 6, then tick on the grading sheet the English course (English as a Second Language, First Language or to decide), the maths tier (Extended, Core or to decide), the readiness (Ready, Ready with support or Not yet) and the maths support (English of maths, problem solving, content gaps or none), and give your reasons in the assessor's comment.

Interviewer guide: Years 7 to 10

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each student go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`).

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (3 to 5 minutes; start Level 6 for Year 7, 7 for Year 8, 8 for Year 9, 9 for Year 10; follow `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and write the points on the Reading front sheet, `forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Pace of speech. Speak at a steady, clear pace, with a short pause after each sentence. Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group, and use it for the instructions and meaning questions of the sentence reading too. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said": what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?
	How did you travel here today?	Did you come by car?	What do you like or dislike about your city?
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?
	Which subject do you find hardest? What do you do when work is difficult?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard.
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read in English?	What helps you most when you learn new words?
	How do you feel about learning all your subjects in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What will be hardest, and how will you deal with it?
Interests	What do you enjoy doing outside school?	Do you like sport, music or art?	What have you achieved in it that you are proud of?
	Tell me about a book, film or game you enjoyed.	Do you like reading? What kind of books?	Why did it stay in your mind?
	Do you take part in any clubs, competitions, volunteering or service?	Do you help at home or in your community?	What did you learn from it?
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school?	Do you have good friends?	How do you help a friend who is having a bad day?
	How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities and rest?

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to do in the future?	Do you have a dream job?	What steps would get you there?
	Where would you like to study after school, and what would you study?	China or another country?	Why does that place or subject interest you?
	Why do you want to join the international programme? Whose idea was it?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope it will give you that your school now does not?
	What kind of person do you want to be at our school?	Do you want to join clubs?	What could you give to our school community?
Values (choose one)	A classmate asks to copy your homework. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy homework?	Why does honesty matter in learning?
	A new student is sitting alone at lunch. What do you do?	Would you talk to them?	Why might someone find it hard to join a group?
Opinion (to hear extended speaking)	Should students have homework every day? Why, or why not?	Do you like homework?	What would be a better system? Give an example.
	Should phones be allowed in school?	Do you use a phone at school now?	What are the strongest arguments on the other side?
Year 10 only	Which IGCSE subjects would you like to take, and why?	Which subjects do you like best?	How do they connect to your future plans?
	The IGCSE course takes two years. How will you manage starting a new course in English?	Will it be hard for you?	What support will you look for, and from whom?
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?	

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, using the evidence from the whole interview, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** (how much of your English they understood) with the same letters. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

3. Suitability

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet from what you saw and heard: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rate it on the Interview sheet in the same way.

4. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)
- Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary
- Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, they note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 12. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	9	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25	25	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Use a short pause after each sentence, and a longer one with the younger students. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 12 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 12
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.